



Google Photos

Make the most out of this cloud-based gallery app

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AMONGST ONE OF THE MOST POPULAR CLOUD-BASED PHOTO BACKUP AND STORAGE APPS, GOOGLE PHOTOS has a ton of functionalities that can benefit everyone from casual to power users. Since its inception back in 2015, the app has been competing with other giants in the space including Dropbox, OneDrive, iCloud and more. You get a nice, chronological cloud backup of all your media (photos and videos) and it also allows you to free up space in your device, which is especially useful for those of us with a meagre 16 or 32GB of internal storage. Sometimes, ardent photographers and content creators shooting on the phone even find 256GB/512GB storage limiting and Google Photos offers a solution to this pressing issue.

What's more, is that storage is completely free



of charge with one caveat. Your images must be under 16MP and your videos must have a maximum resolution of 1080p. If not, then they get added to your allotted 15GB of free online storage with Google. However, the app does have the capability to downgrade images and videos to fit the free criteria, after asking your permission first, of course. Google

Photos allows for tons of functionalities such as creating collages, albums, animations and more. It even supports Live Photos, if your phone has the ability to take those. Additionally, Google Lens is embedded in the app and can recognise places, products, and more, consequently giving you more information about what you're looking at. Its powerful search algorithm makes finding old photos a breeze since you can use extremely specific search terms such as 'blue top' and 'beach' to get you the very picture you're looking for. Apart from these pretty well-known features, there are a host of lesser-known

tricks you can use to enhance your experience. Here are a few tips and tricks for Google Photos.



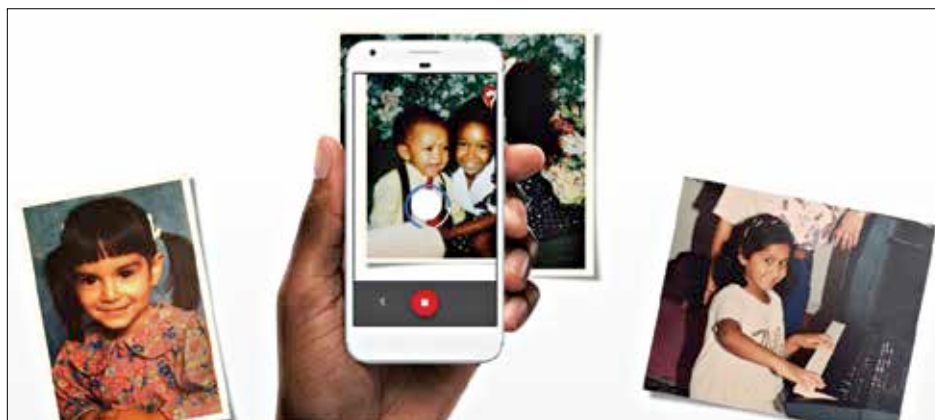
BACK UP OTHER APPS' IMAGES

Ordinarily, Google Photos will back up and sync your photos and videos from your device's main image folder. However, on Android, you can set up Google Photos to backup images from other folders as well. So, your Instagram, Snapchat and WhatsApp images can also be securely stored here. To do this go to Google Photos and click the hamburger menu. Choose Settings, then go to Back up & sync. Over here you can select Back up device folders and toggle on every other folder you want Google Photos to begin backing up.



SCAN PHOTOS

Google Photoscan is an in-built option that comes with Google Photos, however, to access it you will need to download the app. You can do this from the Photos app itself. Once Photoscan is installed, you can easily access it right from the hamburger menu and scan documents, old photographs and more. The best part is that the app utilises a special method



PhotoScan makes digitising old photos simple